STATE OF THE TOWN

This year we welcomed Tom Coneys to the Board of Selectmen. Before he was elected, he spent many years serving on the Budget Advisory Committee and the Capital Improvement Plan Committee. We also thank outgoing Board member Marybeth Quill for her service during the past three years. Her great sense of humor has been missed.

This was a difficult budget year with several increases that would happen even if we made no other changes to 2024's budget. The first increase was the two new police officers that were hired in 2024, but those positions were only partially funded as they had start dates in April and the other in July. To fully fund these positions in 2025 we had to add approximately $88,000 to the proposed budget. A second unavoidable increase to the 2025 budget is the addition of a 53rd week of pay. This happens every five to six years when there are 53 pay weeks instead of the normal 52 pay weeks. This amounted to $53,970. The third unavoidable increase was the ambulance service through Jaffrey Rindge Memorial Ambulance, who, like many others, are struggling to retain and keep employees and to staff the ambulance and provide service they needed to increase employee wages. A significant factor in their struggles is that they have not had competitive salaries until recently. Their survival, as a service, is in the Town's best interest, as they are far less expensive than any other alternative. This increase in the ambulance service added $46,000 to the 2025 budget. The Select Board voted to fund the other half of the substantial increase through a warrant article.

With these budget increases in mind our greatest achievement this year is that we remained firm with our wage plan for our hourly employees in the 2025 budget. We revised our wage scale five years ago to retain skilled personnel and attract qualified people. We were losing employees to other towns and organizations in the area because we could not offer competitive wages. By sticking with our new pay plan, we have stopped the hemorrhaging and even reversed this trend. For the first time in many years, the Police Department has been able to fill its ranks to the level voted upon by the voters. We have even been able to attract experienced officers who do not have to go through months of training at the Police Academy. The Fire Department can fully staff a crew during the day and the Highway Department has been able to hire and retain CDL drivers. To achieve the budget request of the Budget Advisory Committee, the Board had to reduce some positions and make some other cuts to other areas of the operating budget.

We can only stay on this path of improvement by supporting our Town budget this March. We have managed to keep the tax rate for the Town's portion relatively stable for the past few years when the County, Local School, and State Education have mainly gone up. Last year the County Tax Rate was higher than the Towns, which is equal to about one-sixth of a Rindge resident's property taxes.

Achievements

The Town has made great strides in 2024. This year, the Town, through its newly contracted assessing firm, Avitar, reviewed the Elderly Exemptions as required by law to do at least every five years. This was a challenging time for some of our residents as it was something we had not done in the past, however, our Assessing Clerk Kim Gavagan, the staff at the Town Office, and Avitar, handled the inquiries very well. It has brought the Town some tax revenue in the process, as there were several property owners that were no longer qualified, and the value of their property was added back to the overall property valuation of the Town. The Board would like to thank Kim Gavagan, who resigned in the fall, for all her hard work and efforts in the Assessing Department. Her knowledge and sense of humor is missed.

This year the Town welcomed Al Bump to the part time position of Planning Director. This has helped the Town Office tremendously as someone is present during the week to assist with the tedious needs of town planning. Al has been a great asset. The Board of Selectmen also welcomed a part time Executive Secretary, Victoria Stenersen. Victoria will be the one who greets you with a warm smile and (if you are lucky enough),

SYNOPSIS OF THE ANNUAL TOWN MEETING

March 12, 2024

Article 10 Operating Budget

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate as an operating budget, not including appropriations by special warrant articles and other appropriations voted separately, the amounts set forth on the budget posted with the warrant or as amended by vote of the first session, for the purposes set forth therein, totaling Five Million, Three Hundred Fifty-Two Thousand, Seven Hundred and Thirty-Four Dollars ($5,352,734). Should this article be defeated, the Default Budget shall be Five Million, Eighty-Two Thousand, Two Hundred and Thirteen Dollars($5,082,213) which is the same as last year with certain adjustments required by previous action of the Town of Rindge or by law; or the governing body may hold one special meeting, in accordance with RSA 40:13, X and XVI, to take up the issue of a revised operating budget only. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 497 **NO 256**

Article 11 Fire Rescue Truck Lease

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Fifty-Five Thousand, Eleven Dollars ($55,011) for the fifth payment on the Fire Rescue Truck voted on and approved by the Town pursuant to Article 3 of the 2019 Town Warrant. The lease agreement contains an escape clause. This would be the last of five. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 875 **NO 106**

Article 12 Fire Department Equipment Capital Reserve Fund (CRF)

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Forty-five Thousand Dollars ($45,000) to be added to the Fire Department Equipment Capital Reserve Fund and to authorize the withdrawal of Forty-five Thousand Dollars ($45,000) from the Unassigned Fund Balance for this purpose. Further to name the Selectmen as agents to expend. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 778 **NO 202**

Article 13 Revaluation CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Fifty-five Thousand Dollars ($55,000) to be added to the Revaluation Capital Reserve Fund previously established for the Revaluation.to be completed in 2025. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 617 **NO 356**

Article 14 Highway Department CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of One Hundred Thousand Dollars ($100,000) to be added to the Highway Department Capital Reserve Fund previously established, and to authorize the withdrawal of Fifty Thousand Dollars ($50,000) from the Unassigned Fund Balance and Fiftry Thousand Dollars from taxation for this purpose. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 655 **NO 325**

SYNOPSIS OF THE ANNUAL TOWN MEETING

March 12, 2024

Article 15 Building Maintenance CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Fifty Thousand Dollars ($50,000) to be added to the Building Maintenance Capital Reserve Fund previously established. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 624 **NO 354**

Article 16 Police Equipment CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to establish a Police Equipment Capital Reserve Fund under the provisions of RSA 35:1 for the purpose of police vehicles and equipment and to raise and appropriate the sum of Ten Thousand Dollars ($10,000) to be placed in this fund. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 661 **NO 323**

Article 17 Ingalls Memorial Library CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Fifteen Thousand Dollars ($15,000) to be added to the Ingalls Memorial Library Capital Reserve Fund previously established. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 6 in favor, 1 opposed)

YES 716 **NO 270**

Article 18 Recreation Facilities CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of Twenty-Five Thousand Dollars ($25,000) to be added to the Recreation Facilities Capital Reserve Fund previously established. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 6 in favor, 1 opposed)

YES 685 **NO 296**

Article 19 Bridge Maintenance CRF

To see if the Town shall vote to raise and appropriate the sum of One Hundred Thirty-seven Thousand, Five Hundred Thirty-four Dollars ($137,534) to be placed in the Bridge Maintenance Capital Reserve Fund previously established. This sum to come from the Unassigned Fund Balance. No amount to be raised from taxation. Further, to name the Selectmen as agents to expend. (Recommended by the Selectmen 3 in favor, 0 opposed) (Recommended by the Budget Advisory Committee 7 in favor, 0 opposed)

YES 781 **NO 202**

TOWN OF RINDGE
GENERAL FUND

GL NUMBER	DESCRIPTION	2024 ORIGINAL BUDGET	2024 ACTUAL * EXPENDITURES	2025 PROPOSED OPERATING BUDGET	2025 DEFAULT
01-4612.001-5443.000	PROPERTY MAINTENANCE	2,500	916	2,500	2,500
01-4612.001-5550.000	PRINTING	10		10	10
01-4612.001-5554.000	ADVERTISING	100		100	100
01-4612.001-5560.000	DUES AND SUBSCRIPTIONS	540	660	710	540
01-4612.001-5620.000	OFFICE & CLEANING SUPPLIES	25	21	25	25
01-4612.001-5630.000	POSTAGE	70	24	70	70
01-4612.001-5680.000	MISCELLANEOUS EXPENSES	25	7	25	25
01-4612.001-5710.000	STAFF DEVELOPMENT	400		230	400
01-4612.001-5760.000	MILEAGE	250	78	250	250
OPERATING		3,920	1,706	3,920	3,920
Totals for dept 4612.001 - CONSERVATION COMMISSION		6,370	3,428	6,500	6,380
Dept 4711.001 - NOTE PAYABLE					
OPERATING					
01-4711.001-5820.000	PRINCIPAL LONG TERM BOND	130,000	130,000	130,000	130,000
OPERATING		130,000	130,000	130,000	130,000
Totals for dept 4711.001 - NOTE PAYABLE		130,000	130,000	130,000	130,000
Dept 4721.002 - INTEREST LONG TERM BOND					
OPERATING					
01-4721.002-5830.000	INTEREST LONG TERM BOND	42,443	42,443	40,363	42,443
OPERATING		42,443	42,443	40,363	42,443
Totals for dept 4721.002 - INTEREST LONG TERM BOND		42,443	42,443	40,363	42,443
CURRENT BUDGET VS PROPOSED APPROPRIATIONS		**5,352,734**	**5,127,362**	**5,625,278**	**5,487,882**

* Unaudited
** a portion of salary is expensed to Rec Revolving Fund

TOTAL OPERATING EXPENDITURES		1,942,752	1,905,123	1,975,438	1,946,943
TOTAL WAGES & BENEFIT EXPENDITURES		3,409,982	3,222,239	3,649,840	3,540,939
		5,352,734	5,127,362	5,625,278	5,487,882
	SUMMARIES				
	Salaries & Wages	2,306,557	2,208,849	2,555,170	2,347,658
	Overtime	103,982	114,533	114,860	103,982
	Health Insurance	461,689	377,702	388,806	487,576
	Dental Insurance	24,721	21,235	24,484	26,119
	Social Security Tax	101,871	92,487	109,880	111,861
	Medicare Tax	35,180	32,747	39,006	39,469
	Retirement	375,982	374,686	417,634	424,274
		3,409,982	3,222,239	3,649,840	3,540,939

Land Value Only		Acres	Valuation
1A	Current Use RSA 79-A	11,492.12	$916,472
1B	Conservation Restriction Assessment RSA 79-B	0.00	$0
1C	Discretionary Easements RSA 79-C	0.00	$0
1D	Discretionary Preservation Easements RSA 79-D	0.00	$0
1E	Taxation of Land Under Farm Structures RSA 79-F	0.00	$0
1F	Residential Land	6,819.62	$182,781,300
1G	Commercial/Industrial Land	1,551.24	$27,535,100
1H	**Total of Taxable Land**	**19,862.98**	**$211,232,872**
1I	Tax Exempt and Non-Taxable Land	3,433.73	$5,097,400

Buildings Value Only		Structures	Valuation
2A	Residential	0	$424,588,942
2B	Manufactured Housing RSA 674:31	0	$5,336,900
2C	Commercial/Industrial	0	$116,117,100
2D	Discretionary Preservation Easements RSA 79-D	0	$0
2E	Taxation of Farm Structures RSA 79-F	0	$0
2F	**Total of Taxable Buildings**	**0**	**$546,042,942**
2G	Tax Exempt and Non-Taxable Buildings	0	$51,040,758

Utilities & Timber		Valuation
3A	Utilities	$16,888,300
3B	Other Utilities	$0
4	Mature Wood and Timber RSA 79:5	$0
5	**Valuation before Exemption**	**$774,164,114**

Exemptions		Total Granted	Valuation
6	Certain Disabled Veterans RSA 72:36-a	1	$331,400
7	Improvements to Assist the Deaf RSA 72:38-b V	1	$16,186
8	Improvements to Assist Persons with Disabilities RSA 72:37-a	2	$8,277
9	School Dining/Dormitory/Kitchen Exemption RSA 72:23-IV	2	$300,000
10A	Non-Utility Water & Air Pollution Control Exemption RSA 72:12	0	$0
10B	Utility Water & Air Polution Control Exemption RSA 72:12-a	0	$0
11	**Modified Assessed Value of All Properties**		**$773,508,251**

Optional Exemptions		Amount Per	Total	Valuation
12	Blind Exemption RSA 72:37	$15,000	2	$30,000
13	Elderly Exemption RSA 72:39-a,b	$0	44	$5,009,195
14	Deaf Exemption RSA 72:38-b	$0	0	$0
15	Disabled Exemption RSA 72:37-b	$100,000	20	$1,648,985
16	Wood Heating Energy Systems Exemption RSA 72:70	$0	0	$0
17	Solar Energy Systems Exemption RSA 72:62	$0	2	$38,750
18	Wind Powered Energy Systems Exemption RSA 72:66	$0	0	$0
19	Additional School Dining/Dorm/Kitchen Exemptions RSA 72:23	$0	0	$0
19A	Electric Energy Storage Systems RSA 72:85	$0	0	$0
19B	Renewable Generation Facilities & Electric Energy Systems	$0	0	$0
20	**Total Dollar Amount of Exemptions**			**$6,726,930**
21A	**Net Valuation**			**$766,781,321**
21B	**Less TIF Retained Value**			**$0**
21C	**Net Valuation Adjusted to Remove TIF Retained Value**			**$766,781,321**
21D	**Less Commercial/Industrial Construction Exemption**			**$0**
21E	**Net Valuation Adjusted to Remove TIF Retained Value and Comm/Ind Construction**			**$766,781,321**
22	**Less Utilities**			**$16,888,300**
23A	**Net Valuation without Utilities**			**$749,893,021**
23B	**Net Valuation without Utilities, Adjusted to Remove TIF Retained Value**			**$749,893,021**

Utility Value Appraiser

Avitar

The municipality **DOES NOT** use DRA utility values. The municipality **IS NOT** equalized by the ratio.

Electric Company Name	Distr.	Distr. (Other)	Gen.	Trans.	Valuation
NEW ENGLAND POWER COMPANY	$954,400	$0	$0	$0	$954,400
PSNH DBA EVERSOURCE ENERGY	$8,464,800	$222,100	$0	$7,247,000	$15,933,900
	$9,419,200	**$222,100**	**$0**	**$7,247,000**	**$16,888,300**

Veteran's Tax Credits	Limits	Number	Est. Tax Credits
Veterans' Tax Credit RSA 72:28	$500	195	$97,500
Surviving Spouse RSA 72:29-a	$700	3	$2,100
Tax Credit for Service-Connected Total Disability RSA 72:35	$4,000	36	$144,000
All Veterans Tax Credit RSA 72:28-b	$500	50	$25,000
Combat Service Tax Credit RSA 72:28-c	$0	0	$0
		284	**$268,600**

Deaf & Disabled Exemption Report

Deaf Income Limits	
Single	$0
Married	$0

Deaf Asset Limits	
Single	$0
Married	$0

Disabled Income Limits	
Single	$35,000
Married	$49,000

Disabled Asset Limits	
Single	$150,000
Married	$150,000

Elderly Exemption Report

First-time Filers Granted Elderly Exemption for the Current Tax Year

Age	Number
65-74	1
75-79	0
80+	0

Total Number of Individuals Granted Elderly Exemptions for the Current Tax Year and Total Number of Exemptions Granted

Age	Number	Amount	Maximum	Total
65-74	14	$100,000	$1,400,000	$1,151,300
75-79	13	$140,000	$1,820,000	$1,536,895
80+	17	$200,000	$3,400,000	$2,321,000
	44		**$6,620,000**	**$5,009,195**

Income Limits	
Single	$35,000
Married	$49,000

Asset Limits	
Single	$150,000
Married	$150,000

Has the municipality adopted an exemption for Electric Energy Systems? (RSA 72:85)
Granted/Adopted? No **Properties:**

Has the municipality adopted an exemption for Renewable Gen. Facility & Electric Energy Storage? (RSA 72:87)
Granted/Adopted? No **Properties:**

Has the municipality adopted Community Tax Relief Incentive? (RSA 79-E)
Granted/Adopted? No **Structures:**

Has the municipality adopted Taxation of Certain Chartered Public School Facilities? (RSA 79-H)
Granted/Adopted? No **Properties:**

Has the municipality adopted Taxation of Qualifying Historic Buildings? (RSA 79-G)
Granted/Adopted? No **Properties:**

Has the municipality adopted the optional commercial and industrial construction exemption? (RSA 72:76-78 or RSA 72:80-83)
Granted/Adopted? No **Properties:**
Percent of assessed value attributable to new construction to be exempted:
Total Exemption Granted:

Has the municipality granted any credits under the low-income housing tax credit tax program? (RSA 75:1-a)
Granted/Adopted? Yes **Properties:** 1
Assessed value prior to effective date of RSA 75:1-a: 2,665,200
Current Assessed Value: $983,800